

# SGSU Annual General Meeting

## Minutes

09-30-2026, 13:00

**Executive Board members:** Will Groff, Pat Chintanoo, Isaac Marchand, Noah Ripstein, Joey Hotz, Evan Shamov

**Students:** PH Chan, KC Tsiolis, Yovna Junglee, Leo Watson, Denis Khatnyuk, Luis Sierra, Benjamin Smith, Morgan Huang, Alexander Valancia Sanchez, Arian Hashemzade

*Meeting Opened at 13:00*

### Business

#### 1. Welcome and Introductions

- Outgoing President Luis opened the Annual General Meeting. The incoming President Will introduced the current executive team.
- Department looking to expand PhD program
  - Department wants to keep us happy but will start being short on available desk
  - Communication: students not coming in regularly should consider desk-sharing

#### 2. Goals for the Upcoming Year

- Maintain the existing roster of social and academic events established last year.
- Introduce additional practical workshops, with plans to explore targeted departmental funding to support these sessions directly.

#### 3. Budget Overview and Surplus Management

Will presented an update on the union's finances, noting a remaining surplus of approximately \$4,500 originating from the COVID period:

- Discussed whether to continue aggressively drawing down the surplus, given that the majority of students from that cohort have now graduated.
- Agreed that maintaining the current planned annual deficit of \$500-\$600 remains a reasonable approach to gradually wind down the reserve.

#### 4. Event Suggestions and Scheduling

- Coordinate outings to encourage attendance at Chebyshev FC games, particularly during the playoffs as team highlight edits from Leo continue to build the hype.
- Look into subsidizing tickets for a Toronto Blue Jays game. Not much interest.
- Organise a group outing to a Varsity game taking advantage of free student admission.
- Shift pub night earlier in the academic calendar:
  - November or December was suggested as an option.
  - January was highlighted as an ideal window given lighter workloads at the start of the winter term.

#### 5. Practical Workshops

- Organize an industry panel with a less formal, more conversational structure than in previous years.
- Host a workshop on effectively integrating AI tools into PhD research workflows. The executive will possibly reach out to Rohan to gauge interest in leading or contributing to this session, given his prior work in the area.

#### 6. Open Forum

- Noah propose starting a private equity fund with surplus: noted, declined
- Alternative non-sport activity were proposed such as going to TSO or visiting the ROM.
- Introducing a trivia pub night was proposed and well received as an extra activity to the already existing pub-night
- A spelling bee was proposed, which could be organized and hosted within the department at almost no cost

*Meeting Closed at 13:49*